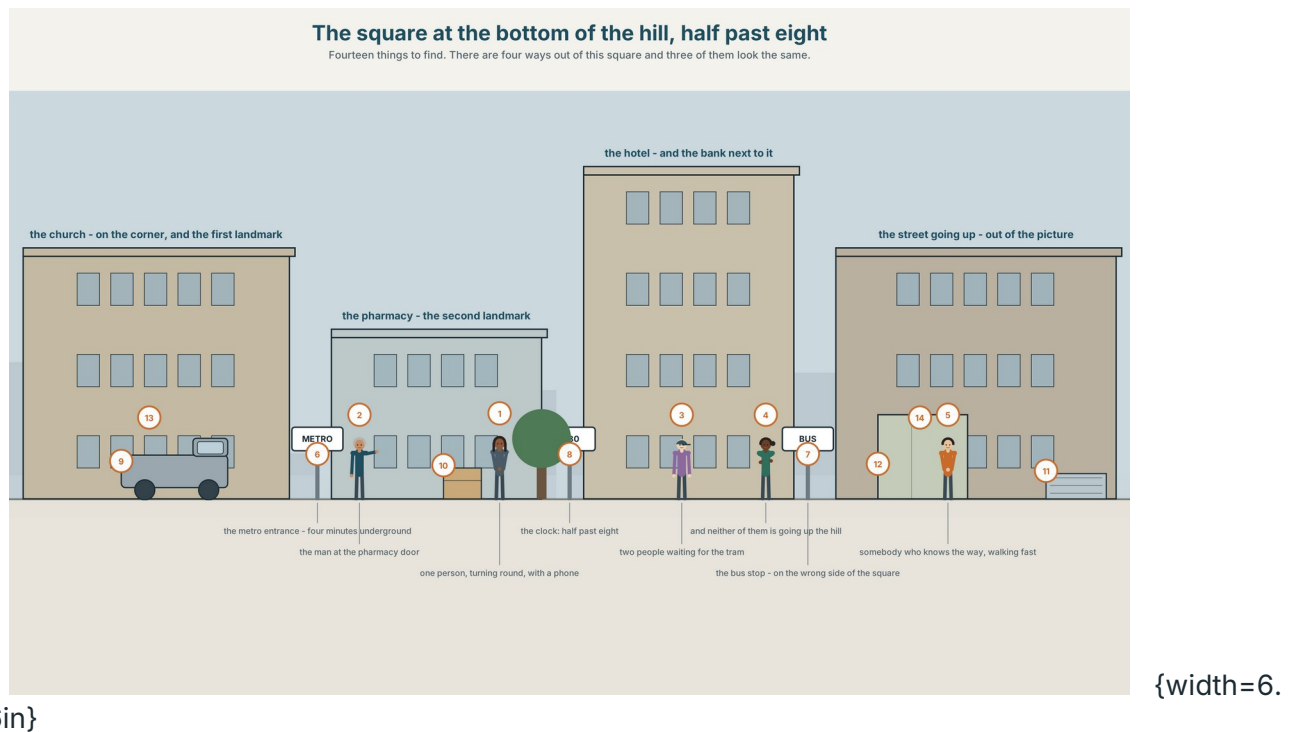


Table of Contents

A1.1 • Unit 9 • Five Minutes from the Metro

English Animated • *Starting Out* • Escola Monte, Lisbon Student's Book pages 182–203 • 22 pp • ~9 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



The square at the bottom of the hill, half past eight — Fourteen things to find. There are four ways out of this square and three of them look the same.

How do you find your way?

By the end of this unit you can give directions that somebody can actually follow.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

A square with four ways out of it and one person turning round in the middle

prepositions of place and movement
• the imperative • 22 words for the city • *on*, *in* and *at* for time • where the stress goes in a compound word
You direct somebody who cannot

◆ A • THE WORLD

A square with four ways out of it and
one person turning round in the
middle

see what you can see

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

- ☐ a street ☐ a square ☐ a corner ☐ a station ☐ a church ☐ a bank ☐ a hotel ☐ a pharmacy
☐ a hill ☐ a bus stop ☐ traffic lights ☐ a tram ☐ a taxi ☐ a bridge

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

a museum · a library · a train

0B • Guess it

Look at the person in the middle. **Which way are they going to go?** Say one thing. You can use these words:

left · right · up · hill · corner

0C • Say it 🟡

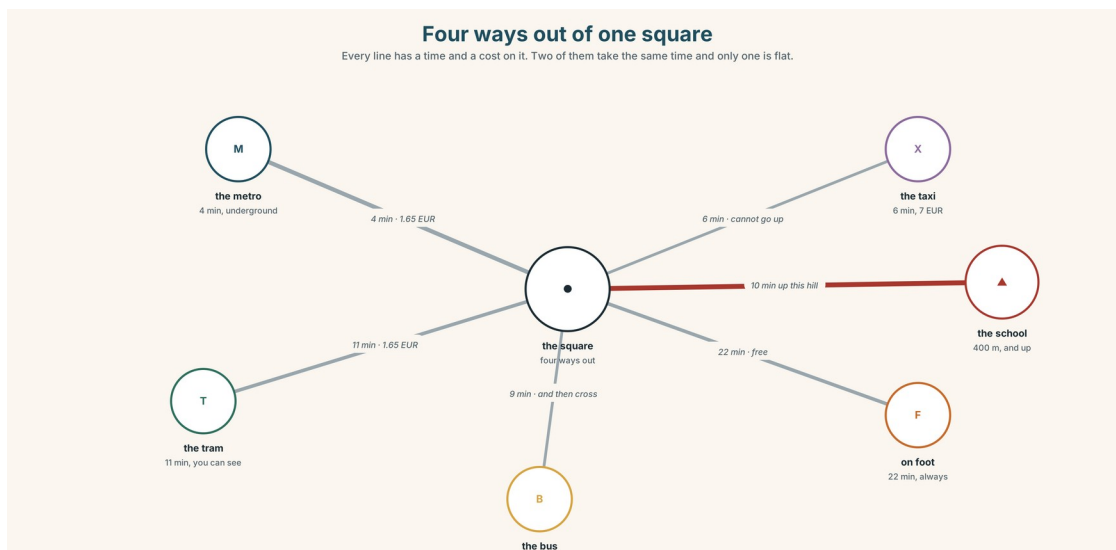
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

How do you get from your home to this building?

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ◆ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — the square and the ways out



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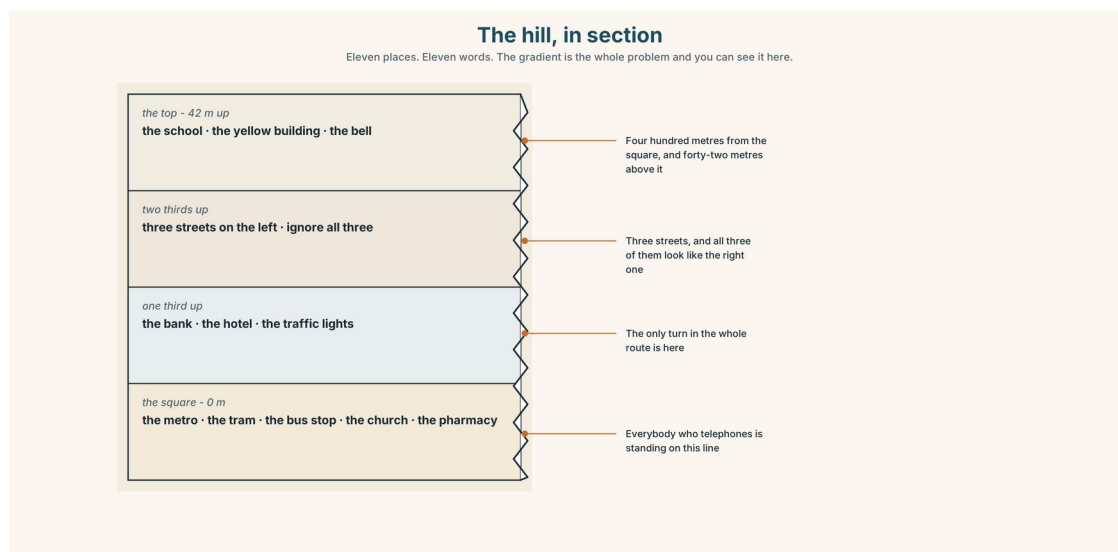
Four ways out of one square — Every line has a time and a cost on it. Two of them take the same time and only one is flat.

metro	Four minutes underground, and you arrive with no idea which way you are facing.
tram	Eleven minutes, and you can see where you are the whole way.
bus	Nine minutes, and it stops on the wrong side of the square.
on foot	Twenty-two minutes, and it is the only one that is always the same length.
taxi	Six minutes, and it cannot get up the hill.

1B • Meet — the words

street • square • corner • bridge • station • church • museum • library • bank • hotel • pharmacy • hill

Write each word under the right picture.



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6in}

The hill, in section — Eleven places. Eleven words. The gradient is the whole problem and you can see it here.

1C • Sort — a place, or a direction?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which, and why?**

hill • left • right • station • behind • square • between • church • opposite • corner

A PLACE	A DIRECTION	BOTH
----------------	--------------------	-------------

1D • Where exactly

next to	touching, or nearly
opposite	across something — a street, a square, a room
behind	you cannot see it from here
between	two things, one on each side, and you have to name both
in front of	not the same as <i>before</i> . <i>Before</i> is time
on the corner	the building that two streets share

Now say them. One of these six needs two nouns after it and the others need one. **Which one, and what happens if you only give it one?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

bus stop · traffic lights · straight on · get on · get off

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. The driver opens the doors and you are at your stop. → _____
2. You are telling somebody not to turn. → _____
3. You are waiting, and there is a shelter and a number on a pole. → _____
4. You are telling somebody where to turn, and there is a red light there. → _____
5. The doors open and you are not at your stop yet. → _____

1F • The hard one

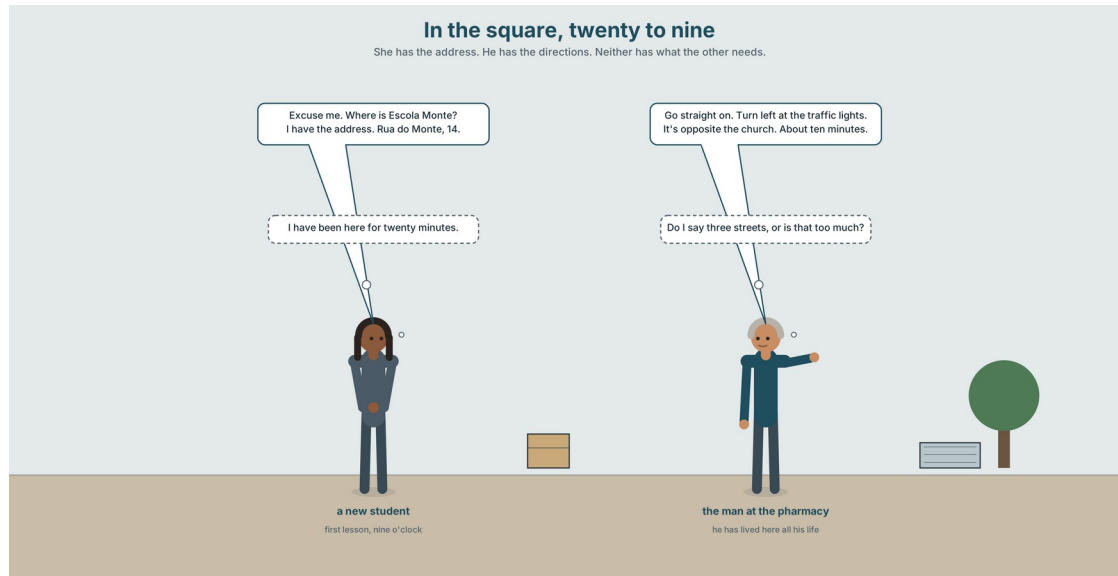
f It's about ten minutes.

Practise it three times. **The most useful lie in any language, and nobody minds it.**

1G • Own it

Write directions from this room to the nearest place where you can buy water, in **three sentences**. Do not write your name. The class decides whose directions would work.

Part 2 • Listening ◆ A • THE WORLD



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6in}

In the square, twenty to nine — She has the address. He has the directions. Neither has what the other needs.

2A • In the square 🎧 Track 9.1

Before you listen. The school is four hundred metres away and six storeys up. **Guess: how many turns are there?**

Listen once. One question. How long does the man say it takes?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	Turn	Landmark
first		
second		
third		

Listen again. True or false?

- The school is opposite the church. ☐ T ☐ F
- You go straight on at the traffic lights. ☐ T ☐ F
- The school is next to a pharmacy. ☐ T ☐ F
- It takes about ten minutes. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

- Go straight on.
- Turn left at the traffic lights.
- It's opposite the church.
- Don't go up the hill.

Sentences 1, 2 and 4 have no *you* in them. Why not, and what are they?

2B • Decoding clinic 🎧 Track 9.2

Twenty seconds of the man at speed. Three jobs.

- 1. Count the directions he gives.
- 2. In *bus stop* and *traffic lights*, which word is louder — the first or the second?
- 3. He says one landmark twice. Which, and why do you think he repeats it?

Transcripts, page 155.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Telling somebody where, and telling them to go

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

- 1. What is the first word in sentences 1, 2 and 4?
- 2. Is there a subject in those three?
- 3. How do you make the negative one?
- 4. In sentence 3, is *opposite* about where something is, or about going somewhere?

3B • See

Words that sit still, and words that move

Place words put a dot on the map. Movement words draw a line across it.

The school

is

opposite

the church

—

Go

up

the hill

STILL: next to · opposite · behind · between · in front of · on the corner

MOVING: up · down · along · across · into · out of · past

And the instruction has no subject at all. Go, turn, take, walk - the plain verb, with don't in front of it for the negative.

6in}

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Words that sit still, and words that move — Place words put a dot on the map. Movement words draw a line across it.

3C • Know

where it is	next to · opposite · behind · between ... and ... · in front of · on the corner	The school is opposite the church.
where you go	up · down · along · across · into · out of ·	Go up the hill. Walk past the bank.

	<i>past</i>	
the imperative	the plain verb, and no subject	<i>Go straight on. Turn left. Take the second street.</i>
the negative imperative	<i>don't</i> + the plain verb	<i>Don't go up the hill. Don't turn at the first corner.</i>

The imperative is not rude. In directions, in recipes and on signs, it is the normal and polite form. The rudeness, when there is any, is in the voice, not in the grammar.

at, on and in - three sizes of container
The same three words you use for places, reused for time, and the shapes match.

AT	.	ON		IN	
a point	six o'clock · night · the weekend	a named day	Monday · the first of May	a long stretch	the morning · May · 2026

Small to large, left to right. The two that break the pattern are at night and at the weekend, and they are worth learning as single words.

6in}

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at, on and in - three sizes of container — The same three words you use for places, reused for time, and the shapes match.

at	a point: <i>at six o'clock · at night · at the weekend</i>
on	a named day: <i>on Monday · on the first of May</i>
in	a long stretch: <i>in the morning · in May · in 2026</i>

Why it matters. Directions are the first thing you give a stranger and the first thing a stranger gives you, and both of you are in a hurry.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with **on, in, at, opposite, next to** or **between**.

The school is (1) _____ the church, across the square. The pharmacy is (2) _____ the bank — there is one on each side of it. Come (3) _____ Monday, (4) _____ the morning. The class starts (5) _____ nine o'clock. The bus stop is (6) _____ the hotel, almost touching it.

3E • Use — guided

Make each one an instruction, then make it negative.

1. You turn left at the traffic lights.
2. You go straight on.
3. You take the second street.

4. You get off at the square.
5. You walk up the hill.

3F • Use — open

In pairs, back to back. One of you has a map. The other has the same map with four things missing. **Fill the gaps by speaking only.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. _____ left at the traffic lights. *(the instruction)*
2. _____ go up the hill. *(the negative instruction)*
3. The school is _____ the church, across the square.
4. Come _____ Monday, _____ the morning. *(two words)*
5. × *You turn left at the lights.* → make it an instruction.
6. × *The bank is between the pharmacy.* → correct it.

The bracket with nothing to close on

×
The bank is between the pharmacy.

Between needs two sides. With one noun after it the listener waits for the second and the sentence never finishes. It is the only preposition in this unit that takes two objects, and the word that joins them is and, never with or or.

✓
The bank is between the pharmacy and the hotel.

Now the bracket closes. Both sides are named and the listener can place the bank exactly. If you only know one side, use next to or opposite instead - they take one object and they are just as precise.

What the writer thought:
Learners reach for between because it feels like the strongest place word. It is, but only when you can name both sides. Half a between is less useful than a whole next to.

6in}

The bracket with nothing to close on — The bracket with nothing to close on

0–3 → Workbook pp. 36–39. **4–5** → Part 6. **6** → page 200.

Part 4 • Speaking ◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

4A • Fluency starter — the blind route

One person closes their eyes. The class directs them from their chair to the door. **One instruction per person. Nobody may touch them.**

4B • The functional core — giving directions

The same route, written twice
Landmarks on the left. Metres on the right. Both of them are accurate.

landmarks

church · pharmacy · traffic lights · yellow building — 9 of 10

metres

120 m · turn · 240 m · turn · 40 m — 3 of 10

Find the six. Nine out of ten people followed one of these successfully. Which, and why is accuracy not the reason?

6 differences — find them all

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The same route, written twice — Landmarks on the left. Metres on the right. Both of them are accurate.

Language Bank

the instruction

Go straight on. Turn left. Take the second street. Walk past the bank.

the landmark

at the traffic lights · opposite the church · on the corner · next to the pharmacy

the transport

get on at the square · get off at the second stop · by bus · on foot

the time

It's about ten minutes.

Information gap. Learner A has the route from the metro. Learner B has the route from the tram. Find the one place where the two routes meet.

4C • The performance — direct somebody who cannot see

Your partner closes their eyes and you direct them from the square to the school. **Two minutes.** You must:

use three landmarks · give one negative instruction · say how long it takes · warn them about one thing before they reach it

Record it.

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did the speaker ever say *left* or *right* without a landmark?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did every turn have something you can see attached to it? ☐ Did I say the hard part before it happened, not after?

Part 5 • Reading ♦ A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**One in four never arrives.**" What do you think goes wrong?

5B • Read — sixty seconds

One in four never arrives

The school's website says: *Escola Monte. Five minutes from Alto metro station.*

That is true. It is four hundred metres. Four hundred metres on flat ground is five minutes.

The four hundred metres are up a hill with a gradient of one in eight, and there are four ways out of the square at the bottom, and three of them look the same.

Last September, twenty-eight people came for the first lesson of the beginners' course. Ana booked thirty-seven. Seven of the nine who did not come telephoned, and six of those seven telephoned from somewhere in the square.

Ana walked down to the square and brought them up, one at a time, over forty minutes. She did it again in January. Nobody has changed the website.

5C • Answer

1. How far is the school from the metro?
2. How many ways out of the square are there?
3. How many people came in September?
4. How many of the missing seven telephoned from the square?
5. **Why is the website not wrong, and why is it still the problem?**
6. **Ana solved it twice by walking down. Why is that not a solution?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

flat ground • a gradient of one in eight • look the same • one at a time • nobody has changed it

5E • The counter-text

The How to find us page

Everything on it is true. The biggest thing on the page is a telephone number.

ESCOLA MONTE - HOW TO FIND US

Address	Rua do Monte 14, 1200 Lisboa
---------	------------------------------

GETTING HERE

Metro	5 minutes from Alto
Bus	3 minutes from the square
Tram	not mentioned
Parking	not mentioned

THE MAP ON THE PAGE

Street names	none
Landmarks	none
The hill	not shown - the map is flat
Size	4 cm wide

AND AT THE BOTTOM, IN BOLD, 18 POINT:

"Lost? Telephone 21 333 4455." It is the largest thing on the page. Somebody knew about the problem and solved it with a telephone number instead of with two more sentences of directions.

True. Four hundred metres, and five minutes on flat ground

Three minutes from the square - and the square is the problem

A map with no names on it is a picture, not a map

The one fact that matters most is the one the map cannot show

The biggest thing on the page is an admission

6in}

The How to find us page — Everything on it is true. The biggest thing on the page is a telephone number.

Read the page and answer.

1. What is the address?
2. **How many minutes does it say from the metro, and from the bus stop?**
3. What is missing from the map?
4. **Why is the telephone number the biggest thing on the page, and what does that tell you?**

5F • Two texts

The website says five minutes. The reading says one in four never arrives.

Which number should the school change? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Getting there

Six decisions between the square and the door
In four of the six, the obvious choice is the wrong one.

1



1 Out of the metro - which way?

2



2 The church: go past it, not round it

3



3 The traffic lights: turn LEFT

4



4 Three streets on the left: all wrong

5



5 The hill: keep going, 4 minutes

6



6 The yellow building: ring the bell

{width=6.

6in}

Six decisions between the square and the door — In four of the six, the obvious choice is the wrong one.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

get on / get off

for buses, trams, trains and the metro

by bus / on foot

by for vehicles, and *on foot* is the odd one out

in the morning / at night

the one pair that does not follow the shape

on Monday

never *in Monday*

6B • Say them

bus • tram • train • metro • taxi • on foot • by bus • get on • get off

6C • Chunk

1. _____ **Monday** — a named day
2. _____ **the morning** — a long stretch
3. _____ **six o'clock** — a point
4. _____ **foot** — the one that is not *by*
5. _____ **bus** — a vehicle
6. **get** _____ — the doors open and you are there

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **on**, **in** or **at**?

1. _____ the first of May
 2. _____ six o'clock
 3. _____ Monday
 4. _____ the weekend
 5. _____ the morning
 6. _____ night
-

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Two words, one stress

Two words, one stress
In a compound the first word is louder. In an ordinary phrase it is the second.

● BUS	● stop	a compound - one thing, with a name
● TRAF-fic	● lights	a compound
● POST	● of-fice	a compound
● a big	● STREET	an ordinary phrase - adjective + noun
● the next	● COR-ner	an ordinary phrase
● a	● GREEN-house	a building for plants
● a green	● HOUSE	a house that is green

6in}

{width=6.

Two words, one stress — In a compound the first word is louder. In an ordinary phrase it is the second.

7A • Hear

compounds — the FIRST word is louder: *BUS stop · TRAFfic lights · POST office · RAILway station*
phrases — the SECOND word is louder: *a big STREET · the next CORner · a long HILL*

7B • Say

Say each group three times. Then say this:

The BUS stop is on a big STREET. — one compound, one phrase, opposite stresses.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

a GREENhouse — a glass building for plants a green HOUSE — a house that is green

Same four syllables. The stress is the only difference, and it changes the thing. Which is which?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **direct somebody from this room to the street, in six instructions.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

Directions somebody can follow • 40–60 words

8A • Read the model

From Alto metro. Come out and turn right. [where you start, and the first move]

You will see a church and a pharmacy. Walk between them, up the hill. It is steep. [the landmark, the move, and the warning before it happens]

Walk for four minutes. Don't turn. There are three streets on the left — ignore all three. [the part where people get it wrong, said in advance]

We are the yellow building on the right. Ring the bell. [what you will see, and what to do]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. *It is steep.* **Why is that in the directions at all?**
2. *ignore all three.* **Why name the wrong turnings instead of only the right one?**
3. The last line says *ring the bell.* **Why does that matter?**

8B • The anti-model

We are at number 14, Rua do Monte, 1200 Lisbon. Five minutes from Alto metro station.
Telephone 21 333 4455.

Correct English, true, and one in four people never arrive. **Rewrite it with two landmarks, one warning and one instruction about what to do when you get there.**

8C • Plan

where you start → landmark and move → the wrong turnings, named → what you will see, and what to do

8D • Write — 40 to 60 words

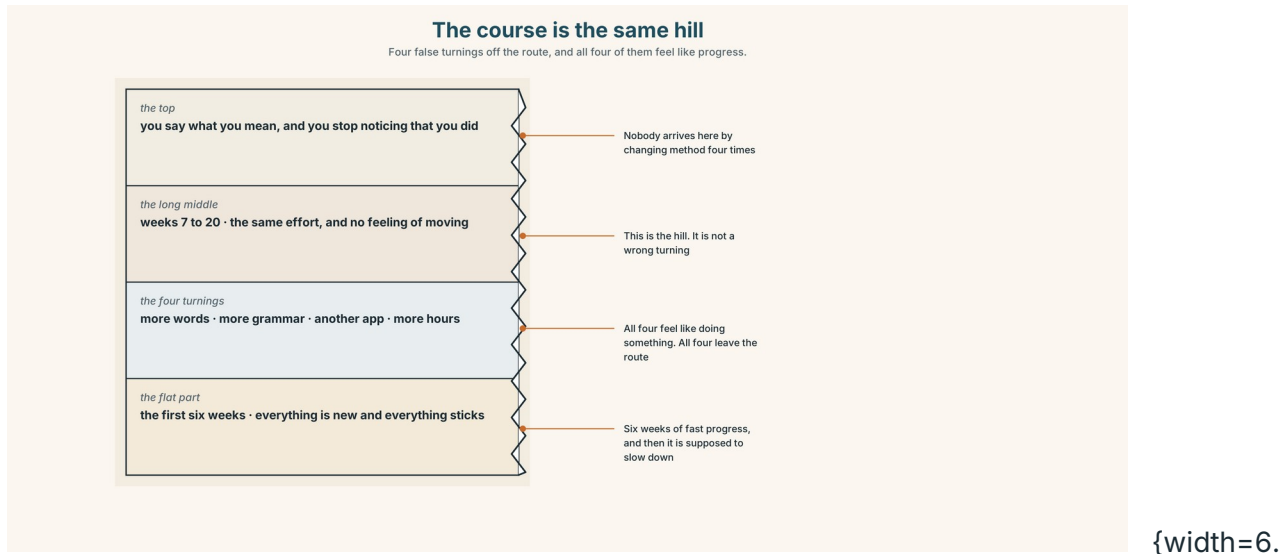
8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Is there a landmark attached to every turn? ☐ Is there one warning about something before it happens?

8F • Publish

Swap with someone who does not know your route. **They follow it on a map and mark where they got lost.**

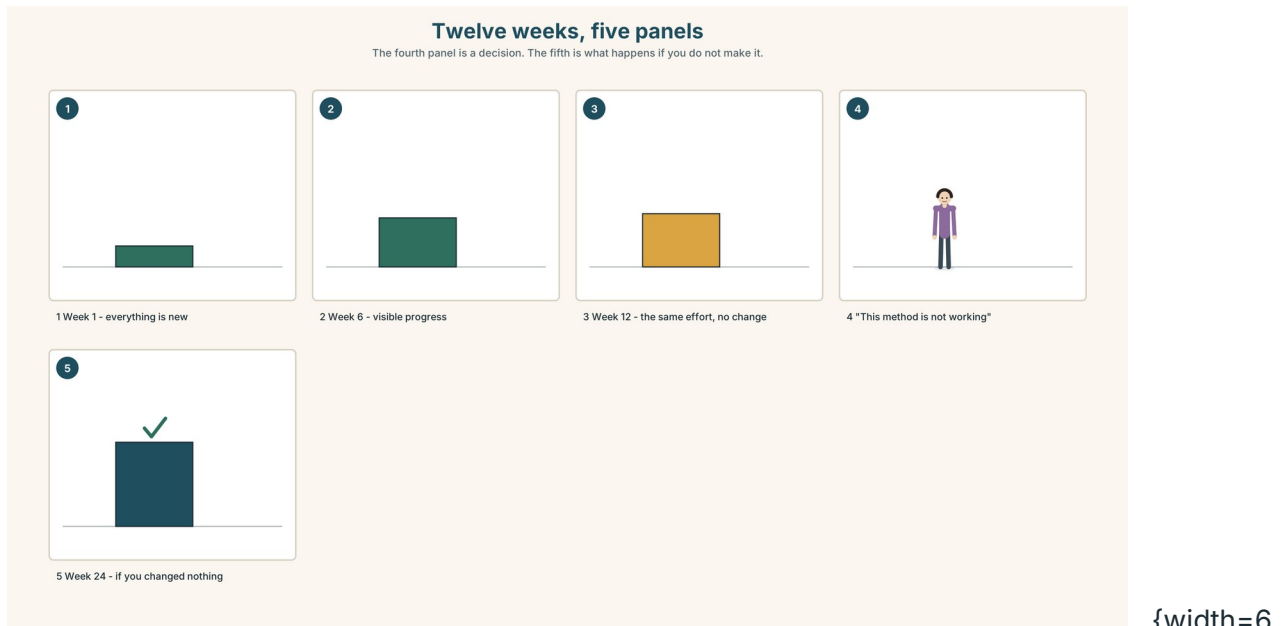
STUDY FILE • Knowing where you are



6in}

The course is the same hill — Four false turnings off the route, and all four of them feel like progress.

9A • Four turnings



6in}

Twelve weeks, five panels — The fourth panel is a decision. The fifth is what happens if you do not make it.

The flat part	the first six weeks. Everything is new and everything sticks
The hill	weeks seven to twenty. The same effort, and it feels like nothing
What people do	change method, because the hill feels like a wrong turning
What the hill is	the normal shape of learning anything

9B • A landmark, not a feeling

You cannot feel progress at A1, because the thing you measure with is the thing that is changing. **Pick a landmark instead.** Record yourself today. Record the same thirty seconds in eight weeks.

9C • Role play — directing a beginner

In pairs. One of you started three months after the other. **Give them directions through the next three months.** Use the imperative. Name one wrong turning.

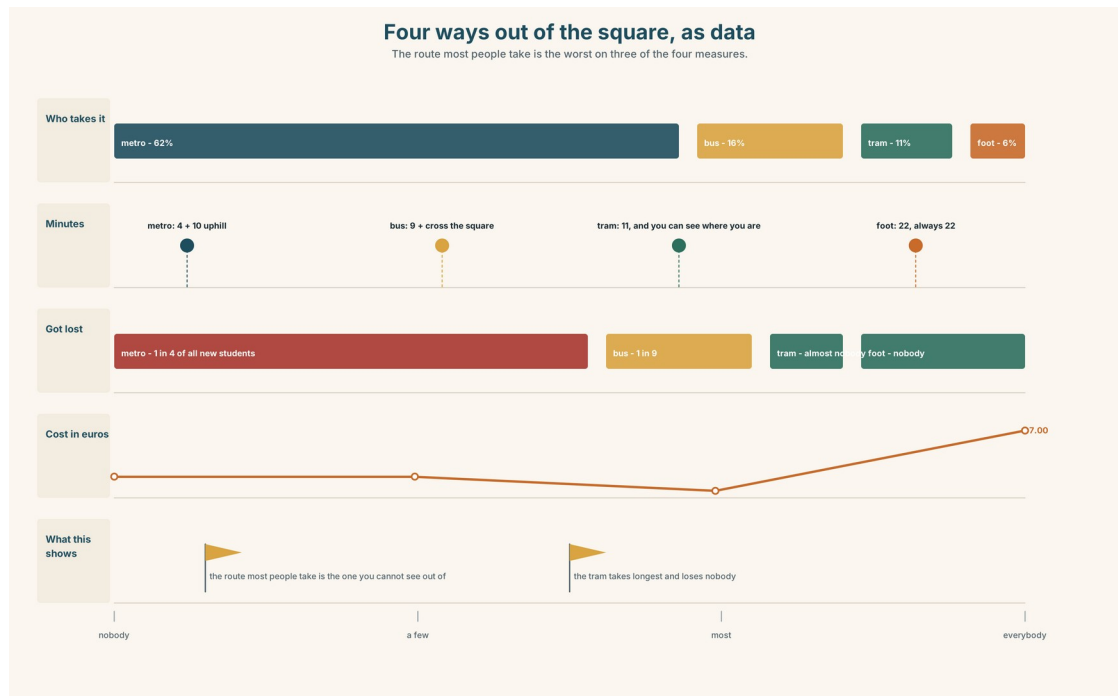
9D • Where are you, exactly?

Not *good* or *bad*. **Name one thing you could not do in September and can do now.** That is your position. It is the only honest one.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Record thirty seconds answering the question from 0C. Label it with today's date and put it somewhere you will not lose it. You will listen to it in Unit 10 of the next book.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



{width=6.

6in}

Four ways out of the square, as data — The route most people take is the worst on three of the four measures.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the route from the metro. Half has the route from the tram. **Build one set of directions that works from both, by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

A visitor telephones from the square and says: *I can see a church.* **Direct them in three sentences.** You cannot see what they see.

10C • Online

Write **one message** giving a classmate directions to a place near here. **Two sentences.** One must contain a warning.

10D • Your language

Does your language say *left* and *right*, or does it use north and south, or uphill and downhill? **Give directions from the square to the school in your language.** What do you use?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Five minutes from the metro

One in four new students does not arrive at the first lesson. Six out of seven of those who telephone are standing in the square at the bottom of the hill.

Option one: rewrite the website. Two landmarks, one warning about the hill, and the three streets to ignore. Free, and it takes twenty minutes.

Option two: put a sign in the square. The city charges one hundred and forty euros a year for a sign on a pole, and it has to be approved.

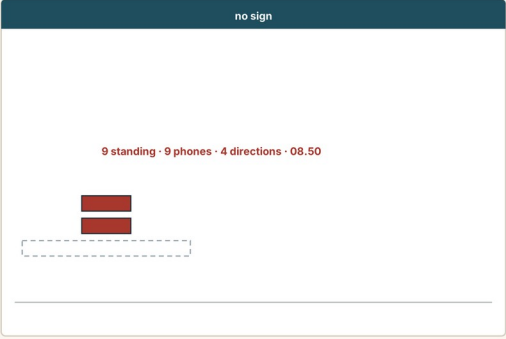
Option three: meet every new student at the metro for the first week of each term. It works perfectly, it costs Ana four hours a term, and it stops the moment she is busy.

11A • The evidence

The square at ten to nine in September
The same nine people, drawn twice. One pole is different.

no sign

9 standing · 9 phones · 4 directions · 08.50



one sign

9 walking · 1 direction · 1 pole · 08.50



Find the six. One of them is a clock, and it tells you what the sign was actually worth.
6 differences — find them all

{width=6.

6in}

The square at ten to nine in September — The same nine people, drawn twice. One pole is different.

 **Track 9.6.** A new student, 20 seconds: "I was in the square for twenty minutes. I had the address. I had the map on my phone. The map says you are here, and I was here. I didn't know which street."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the school should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: street · square · corner · hill · sign · metro · bus stop

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the school should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Rewrite the website, and name the three streets you should not take. The sign and the walking both fix the square. The website is where the student is standing two weeks before they are ever in the square, and it is the only one of the three that is free.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. Ana rewrote the page. She added two landmarks, one line that said *it is a steep hill, allow ten minutes*, and the sentence *there are three streets on the left — ignore all three*. In January, twenty-six of twenty-seven arrived.

Then something she did not expect: the students who arrived were less nervous than previous years, not only less lost. The line about the hill had told them that the school knew what the walk was like.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

Twenty minutes of writing fixed something two hundred euros could not. What was actually broken?

Part 12 • Landing ◆ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. _____ left at the traffic lights. (*the instruction*)
2. _____ go up the hill. (*the negative instruction*)
3. The school is _____ the church, across the square.
4. The pharmacy is _____ the bank and the hotel. (*two things, one on each side*)
5. _____ Monday
6. _____ the morning
7. _____ six o'clock
8. _____ foot
9. _____ bus
10. Where do I _____ ? (*two words — the doors open and you leave*)
11. (*Unit 8*) She's _____ engineer.
12. (*Unit 7*) I _____ go to concerts. (*almost never, two words*)

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write directions from the nearest station to your home, in six sentences. Three must be instructions, one must be negative, two must contain a landmark, and one must say how long it takes.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can give directions somebody can follow. **Evidence:** 4C, 8D ☐ I can say where something is. **Evidence:** 3G ☐ I can use *on*, *in* and *at* for time. **Evidence:** 6D ☐ I can stress a compound word correctly. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE PLACES • street • square • corner • bridge • station • church • museum • library • bank • hotel • pharmacy • hill **WHERE** • left • right • opposite • behind • between • next to • in front of **WHAT YOU SAY** • bus stop • traffic lights • straight on **HOW YOU GET THERE** • bus • tram • train • metro • taxi • on foot • by bus • get on • get off **WHEN** • on Monday • in the morning • at six o'clock **HOW LONG** • It's about ten minutes.

12F • Next

Unit 10 • What is this worth?